단톡방 메시지 읽기: 생파, 칼퇴가 무슨 뜻이에요?

Learn common Korean short forms and use them to read casual group chats.

WHAT THIS IS FOR

You can read short forms like 생파, 칼퇴 and 불금 in a chat, guess new ones from their full words, and choose the full form in polite writing.

1 자주 보는 줄임말과 신조어

1. **단톡방** (group chat)
   Short for 단체 카톡방, a group chat room on a messenger app.
   예: 회식 장소는 단톡방에 올릴게요.
2. **생파** (birthday party)
   Short for 생일 파티.
   예: 토요일에 동생 생파가 있어요.
3. **알바** (part-time job)
   Short for 아르바이트, a part-time job, often held by students.
   예: 주말마다 카페에서 알바를 해요.
4. **혼밥** (eating alone)
   Short for 혼자 밥 먹기. Use it as 혼밥하다.
   예: 점심은 학교 식당에서 혼밥했어요.
5. **칼퇴** (leaving work on time)
   Leaving work right at closing time, sharp as a knife (칼 + 퇴근).
   예: 오늘은 약속이 있어서 칼퇴할 거예요.
6. **불금** (Friday night out)
   From 불타는 금요일, 'burning Friday', a fun night before the weekend.
   예: 불금인데 집에만 있어요?
7. **소확행** (small, sure happiness)
   From 소소하지만 확실한 행복, a small everyday joy.
   예: 퇴근 후 산책이 제 소확행이에요.
8. **워라밸** (work-life balance)
   From 워크 라이프 밸런스, the balance between work and personal life.
   예: 월급보다 워라밸이 더 중요해요.

2 줄임말은 어떻게 만들어요?

Most Korean short forms take the first syllable of each word: 생일 파티 → 생파, 비밀번호 → 비번. When you see a new two- or three-syllable word in a chat, try to guess the long words behind it.

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3 언제 써요?

Short forms are fine in chats and when you talk with friends or coworkers your own age. In emails, reports, and with older people or customers, use the full form: 비밀번호를 알려 주시겠어요?

Short forms change quickly. The words here are common in everyday chats today.

4 YOUR TURN

READ AND USE SHORT FORMS

Use the word list and the tips on page 1 to read, choose or write the right form.

1 Read the message and answer in English: 유나:
이번 불금에 제 생파 해요! 장소는 단톡방에 올릴게요.
①파티는 무슨 요일에 해요?
②장소는 어디에서 확인해요?

2 Make the short form by taking the first syllable of each word:
①남자 친구
②학생 식당
③무료 배송

3 Choose the right word for each blank (알바, 워라밸, 소확행):
①야근이 너무 많아서 ____이 없어요.
②방학 동안 편의점 ____를 할 거예요.
③따뜻한 이불 속에서 책 읽기가 제 ____이에요.

4 Short form or full form? Write S (short form is fine) or F (use the full form):
①교수님께 보내는 이메일
②친한 친구들과의 단톡방
③회사 보고서
④처음 만난 어른께 보내는 메시지

5 Rewrite the sentence using two short forms from the list:
오늘은 정시에 퇴근하고 혼자 밥을 먹을 거예요.

✓ ANSWERS

1) ① On Friday night this week (불금 = 금요일 밤, a Friday night out) ② In the group chat (단톡방)
2) ① 남친 ② 학식 ③ 무배
3) ① 워라밸 ② 알바 ③ 소확행
4) ① F ② S ③ F ④ F
5) 오늘은 칼퇴하고 혼밥할 거예요. (Also possible: 오늘은 칼퇴하고 혼밥을 할 거예요.)

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